Where ONE Stands

An honest account of what is built, what is missing and where the money comes from — graded with **the product's own readiness bands**, because a system that refuses to give students a false score should not give itself one either.

159	30	67	11	9	0
LIVE API ROUTES	DATABASE MIGRATIONS	TEST SUITES	ROLE PORTALS	QUESTION FORMATS	WAYS TO TAKE PAYMENT

01 What ONE is, in one paragraph

ONE is a shared workspace that takes a person from "I am in college" to "I have a job," and lets the college and the employer stand in the same room while it happens. Today those three parties live in three separate worlds — a student with a CV on a laptop, a placement officer with a spreadsheet, an employer with a pile of identical PDFs. ONE puts them on one screen.

The idea that distinguishes it is a refusal. Every competitor sells a *score* — "you are 74% job-ready." ONE gives a **band** instead. Overall readiness runs Not Enough Evidence, Developing, Progressing, Ready For Next Step; each individual topic is graded on the same ladder, topping out at Demonstrated — which is the vocabulary this document borrows to grade the product itself. It always shows the specific records that produced the band, it can be rebuilt from those records at any time, and below four pieces of evidence it declines to guess. An employer never sees it. That restraint is enforced by the database, not by policy — and it is the reason students and colleges will put honest data in, which is what makes everything else worth anything.

02 Build state, by capability

- DEMONSTRATED — real, enforced, end to end
- PROGRESSING — works, with a named limit
- DEVELOPING — partly there, honestly labelled
- NOT ENOUGH EVIDENCE — structure exists, substance does not

Readiness engine

DEMONSTRATED

Evidence in, bands out, with the factor list and the model version stored alongside every snapshot. Recomputable. Refuses to produce a number.

Academic records & verification

DEMONSTRATED

A student declares, the issuing institution verifies, and verification is permanent — a database trigger refuses to reverse it. Only the issuing institution can decide.

Assessment engine

DEMONSTRATED

Governed question bank with review states, blueprint-assembled papers from approved questions only, per-student shuffled papers frozen at start, answer keys never leaving the server, submit-once scoring.

Student profile & documents

DEMONSTRATED

Real file upload, virus-scanned, encrypted per file. If the scanner is unavailable the file is refused rather than stored unchecked.

Institution administration

DEMONSTRATED

Academic structure, roster, CSV import with preview before commit, staff invitations, scoped reporting with cohorts under five suppressed.

Privacy & data rights

DEMONSTRATED

Export everything, request deletion, grant and withdraw consent, legal holds that stop an automatic deletion erasing evidence under investigation.

Hiring pipeline

PROGRESSING

Post, target, apply, shortlist, schedule, score, offer, accept — the whole chain is real. Interviewers see only their assigned interview. No employer-built assessments; no calendar integration.

Platform operations

PROGRESSING

Kill switch per feature, per organisation and per person, every flip stamped with a reason. Trust-and-safety cases, audit log, queue repair. Screens are bare but real.

Security posture

PROGRESSING

Server-side authorization on every request, cross-tenant access impossible by database structure rather than by permission check, backups encrypted to a key the server does not hold. Staff two-factor decided but not switched on. No independent penetration test.

Mobile app

PROGRESSING

Student journey properly built; staff and employer dashboards working. Exams are deliberately laptop-only and the app says so.

Staff role depth

DEVELOPING

Counsellors, analysts and department heads can read their data; several of their actions are not yet wired. The pages say so plainly rather than showing dead buttons.

Learning content

NOT ENOUGH EVIDENCE

The factory is built — taxonomy, versioning, prerequisites, draft→review→publish. The stock is not: a thin technology-oriented seed and no authoring screen.

AI

NOT ENOUGH EVIDENCE

Orchestration built and provider-neutral; the help assistant is grounded in a curated corpus so it cannot invent features. No model connected — held on cloud access. One adapter remains.

Billing

NOT ENOUGH EVIDENCE

Nothing. No plans, subscriptions, entitlements, payment provider or invoices. Deliberately deferred on 6 September; the trigger to start is a paying customer with a date.

> **How to read this table.** These bands are an **assessment**, not a measurement — the same distinction the internal commercial model insists on between actual and assumed figures. The counts above the table are measured from the codebase. The bands are judgement, and should be challenged.

03 What is missing, in the order I would fix it

Ranked by what unblocks the most value soonest, not by size. Several are far cheaper than they look, because the engine behind them already exists and only the door is missing.

01 Nobody can pay us

This is the only major area with zero implementation, and it hides because it has no screens — everything else unbuilt shows as an empty page; this shows as nothing. Manual invoicing works for five pilot colleges and fails at the fiftieth, and fails completely for a student who wants to pay directly.

ALREADY THERE	MISSING
Role and membership gating, which billing can build on without displacing a placeholder.	Plans, subscriptions, entitlements, payment provider, invoices, tax handling.

02 No front door for anyone who is not currently at a college

There is no self-signup anywhere. The only way in is an invitation. A person who graduated before ONE existed has no path to an account — which excludes the most motivated users and the ones most likely to pay personally, and caps our relationship with any person at roughly four years.

The encouraging discovery: **the verification machinery already accepts them.** A qualification names its issuing institution, and the verification queue is scoped by that alone — it never asks whether the person is still enrolled. A 2019 graduate pointing at their old college would land in that college's queue and be verifiable with today's code.

ALREADY THERE	MISSING
Retroactive verification, permanent once granted, issuer-only. Self-reported records cannot be falsely verified.	Self-signup, an alumni-request screen for colleges, notifications.

03 No content library beyond a thin technology seed

The existential one. A platform that promises employability for every field currently serves roughly one. The recommendation is to generate with a model and publish only after a named subject expert approves — the provenance and review machinery was built for exactly this and has been waiting.

A model solves *authoring*. It does not solve *authority*. The reviewer is the product. And depth in three fields beats shallowness across thirty — a student can tell the difference within ten minutes, at which point the credibility is spent rather than built.

ALREADY THERE	MISSING
Taxonomy, versioning, prerequisites, draft→review→publish, provenance columns for model and prompt version.	Stock, an authoring screen, and a named reviewer per field.

04 No feedback reaches a rejected candidate

Arguably the highest-value unbuilt feature in the product. Today a student applies, is rejected, and hears nothing — then repeats the same mistake across forty applications. Employers already fill in structured scorecards; the feature is one scorecard with two visibilities, the employer choosing what is released.

ONE can then do what nothing else can, because it holds both the evidence and the outcome: connect that feedback to the roadmap, and over time say with measured numbers which demonstrated topics actually predict being hired.

05 No interview or speaking practice

Nothing observes a student answering a question. A student never trained on speaking is disadvantaged by default, so this is not optional — and it has to come from model observation, because a coach in every practice session does not scale past one campus.

Three design commitments: the **microphone is checked first and is a gate, not a penalty** — poor audio yields "we could not assess this," never a low band; the output is a band with categories, never a number; and the target is *being understood*, not sounding foreign. Practice is private from employers, permanently.

06 No portable, verified profile

Every door into ONE requires a sign-in. A student can export everything they own, but there is no shareable link a verified record can live behind. The one asset we have spent all this effort making trustworthy is locked inside the building. Needs revocable, scoped, expiring sharing — with the readiness band excluded.

07 Staff two-factor is decided but not on

The decision is recorded and the application already handles the prompt; it needs a separate staff sign-in pool, which needs cloud access. Until then the strongest control on a placement officer's account is a password — today's weakest link. Independent penetration testing should follow before real data arrives at scale.

08 No employer-side assessments

"Send a screening test to 200 applicants" is table stakes for a hiring product, and an employer cannot do it. The entire engine exists on the institution side; this is an extension, not a build from nothing.

09 No calendar

Interview times, exam windows, task due dates and roadmap deadlines are all already recorded. Nobody has built the page that gathers them per person. Unusually cheap for how visible it is — and it should push into Google Calendar and Outlook, where people actually look.

04 Where the revenue comes from

No prices are set and none should be quoted yet. What follows is the shape, ordered by how soon each becomes real.

Colleges, per student per year

WORKS TODAY — MANUALLY

The beachhead. Colleges already hold placement budgets and already pay aptitude-test vendors and training firms; we consolidate several line items rather than creating one. The buyer is judged on a single number we can move and prove.

Friction: slow procurement, tied to the academic year, often needing management sign-off.

Employers, by subscription

WHERE THE MARGIN IS

Access to a verified pool plus the hiring tools. Subscription, not per-hire — per-hire rewards the customer for hiding the outcome and turns the relationship into policing.

Blocker: no employer assessments, no calendar, no ATS connection. A large company will ask what this replaces.

Students and alumni, freemium

AFTER THE FRONT DOOR EXISTS

Largest audience, hardest money. Free learning, profile and applications; paid for what is genuinely scarce — a verified shareable profile, speaking and interview practice, priority access. Small price, large volume.

Verification as a service

THE UNDERRATED ONE

Background verification is already an industry that confirms degrees by chasing a registrar for weeks. We would hold that record, confirmed by the college itself and permanent. It also earns from people who never use the rest of the product — and it gives colleges a reason to join that has nothing to do with current students.

> **The cost that scales is AI.** Every practice session, generated lesson and assistant conversation costs money per use. Per-feature spend caps are already built into the platform — that instinct was right, and it means cost per student must be understood before AI features go wide. **The cost that does not scale is content review:** a subject expert is a fixed cost per field, not per student, so margin improves with scale. Every number in a commercial conversation should be labelled measured or assumed.

05 Two things worth refusing to sell

The readiness band, to employers

It is the most obviously monetisable thing we own, and an employer would pay for "show me everyone rated Demonstrated." Sell it and students start gaming it, colleges start inflating it, and within a year the data — and the product built on it — is worthless. The restraint is the asset.

> **Student data, to anyone**
>
> Same logic, shorter path to the same ending, plus a regulator. If either is proposed in a meeting, the answer is not “that is unethical” — it is “that is the fastest way to destroy the thing we are selling.”

06 The sequence I would follow

1. **Finish the pilot and measure the outcome.**
   Do not build billing yet. Every later conversation depends on one sentence: this college’s placement rate moved by this much.

2. **Open the front door.**
   Self-signup plus the alumni verification request — the cheapest large win on the list, because the engine behind it already works.

3. **Build billing the moment there is a paying customer with a date.**
   That is the trigger already written into the decision to defer it.

4. **Switch on staff two-factor and commission a penetration test**
   before real student data arrives at scale.

5. **Pick one field and make its content genuinely excellent.**
   Use it to win colleges in that field; let it pay for the next field.

6. **Then employers.**
   Close the feedback loop to rejected candidates first — it is what makes the platform worth returning to.

> **The one-line summary.** The product is close to sellable. The ability to get paid is not built at all. The hard parts — governance, provenance, verification, tenant isolation, the refusal to fake a score — are done, and they are the parts that are expensive to retrofit. What remains is stock, a door, and a till.

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